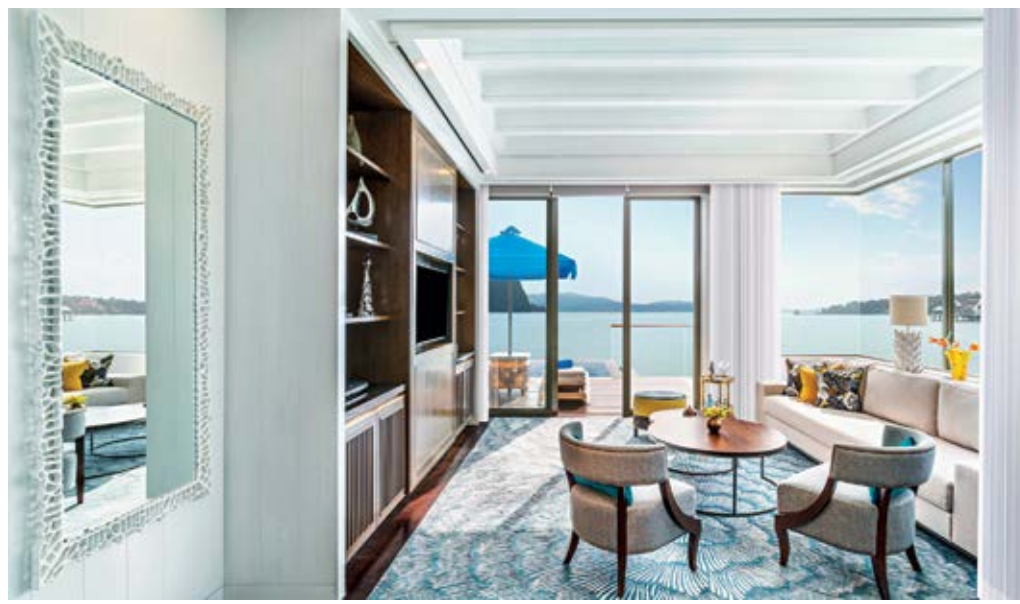








The only thing left to do with the champagne was bathe in it. At the Moorish-inspired St. Regis Langkawi, we were offered champagne at breakfast, before our walks, during them and after, at sundown, and with all meals. Needless to say, everyone was in high spirits throughout. This was a novel experience for me but, as St. Regis reguwlars will know, at their properties around the world, the bubbly hasn't stopped flowing since 1904, when John Jacob Astor IV—known for his legendary parties—opened the St. Regis New York. They don't call it the 'house of celebration' for nothing.

But I'm getting ahead of myself. My first port of call in the island paradise of Langkawi was the sprawling Ritz-Carlton, a luxurious jewel of a property, laid out like a traditional Malay kampong (village) in a rainforest millions of years old. From the floor-to-ceiling windows in my tech-forward suite, I had sweeping views of the ancient coastline. The forest was